

Once we have laid the foundations for a good relationship with money in how we think about it and ourselves – and the relationship between the two – it becomes possible to create sustainable habits and rituals that will help us to engage with our finances in a positive and practical way. Each of these new habits is underpinned by the belief that we are equal to a task that many of us have found near impossible in the past: the task of feeling in control of our money, rather than it being in control of us. Through the small things that we build into our lives every day, and reframing tasks such as budgeting and organizing our bank accounts as something closer to self-care than life admin, we can create a framework of mutually supportive habits that will hold us and give us security, even when circumstances change.

For most of us, the amount that we can earn is finite, whether this is because we're in a job with a fixed salary or because we only have a certain amount of time and resource that we can exchange for money as freelancers and business owners. But what we can spend – the money that flows out of our accounts, is limited by nothing other than our credit limit and our self-discipline. This means that, in order to achieve financial wellbeing, we need to ensure that we're spending mindfully and in a controlled manner, at least most of the time. Our spending habits, and how we respond to marketing and consumer culture, are all heavily influenced by our emotions, and recognizing where our feelings and finances meet enables us to see the warning signs and feel more in control of our